ASSESSMENT OF LOSS — MILLVALE REGION INLAND FLOOD (2021)

Arden Emergency Management Agency

1. The event

Between 7 and 8 inches of rain fell on the Millvale catchment in 66 hours. The river gauge at Millvale exceeded the previous record of record by 2.3 feet. This is the most severe flood in the State's recorded history. 7 counties were included in the declaration.

2. Assessed gross loss

The Agency's assessed gross loss is $595 million. 2,156 homes and businesses were destroyed or damaged beyond economic repair. As with the hurricane assessments the figure is gross and is not reduced by insurance or federal assistance.

3. Why the insured share is low

Insured losses paid on this event were a substantially smaller proportion of assessed loss than for either hurricane. The Agency attributes this to the flood insurance take-up rate in the affected census tracts, which the Insurance Commissioner puts at 22.9 per cent, against 70.9 per cent for wind coverage in the coastal counties. The consequence is that a larger share of the loss from this event was borne by the owners.

4. Repeat exposure

556 of the parcels damaged had been damaged in a previous declared event. The Agency has recommended acquisition of 86 of them but has no appropriation for the purpose.

Final assessment for this event.